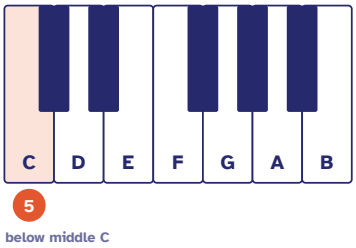
SONG 1

Hot Cross Buns

Three notes, both hands, from today. An old London street song.

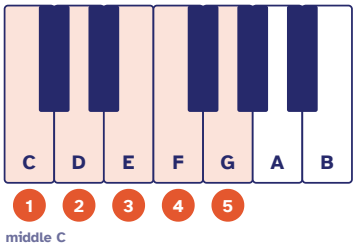
Hear it first

LEFT HAND



Only C: finger 5. Let it ring.

RIGHT HAND



Thumb on middle C, one finger for each key.

THE SONG

Count out loud, 1 2 3 4. One letter, one box. A box split in two: two quick notes, “one-a, pen-ny”.

	3	2	1		3	2	1				
R.H.	E	D	C	—	E	D	C	—			
	1 Hot	2 cross	3 buns	4	1 hot	2 cross	3 buns	4			
L.H.	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—			

	1	1	1	1	2	2	2	2	3	2	1				
R.H.	C	C	C	C	D	D	D	D	E	D	C	—			
	1 one	& a	2 pen	& ny	3 two	& a	4 pen	& ny	1 hot	2 cross	3 buns	4			
L.H.	C	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	C	—	—	—			

- [ ] Left hand alone
- [ ] Right hand alone
- [ ] Both hands
- [ ] For someone

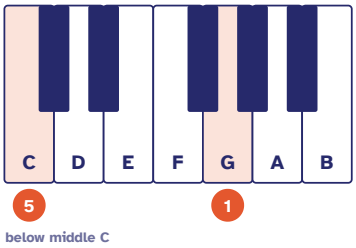
SONG 2

Mary Had a Little Lamb

A song for a little brother, sister or cousin. New: G, with the left thumb.

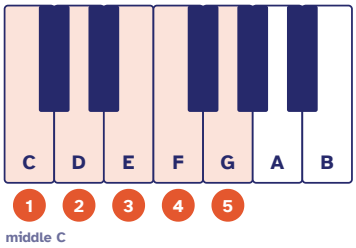
Hear it first

LEFT HAND



C with finger 5, G with the thumb.

RIGHT HAND



Thumb on middle C, one finger for each key.

THE SONG

Count out loud, 1 2 3 4. One letter, one box. A line means keep holding.

	3	2	1	2	3	3	3		2	2	2		3	5	5	
R.H.	E	D	C	D	E	E	E	—	D	D	D	—	E	G	G	—
	1 Ma-	2 ry	3 had	4 a	1 lit-	2 tle	3 lamb	4	1 lit-	2 tle	3 lamb	4	1 lit-	2 tle	3 lamb	4
L.H.	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—

	3	2	1	2	3	3	3	3	2	2	3	2	1			
R.H.	E	D	C	D	E	E	E	E	D	D	E	D	C	—	—	—
	1 Ma-	2 ry	3 had	4 a	1 lit-	2 tle	3 lamb	4 its	1 fleece	2 was	3 white	4 as	1 snow	2	3	4
L.H.	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—

☐ Left hand alone ☐ Right hand alone ☐ Both hands ☐ For someone

SONG 2 · THE LEFT HAND, AGAIN

Mary Had a Little Lamb, Four Ways

You know the song. Now the left hand plays it four new ways: the same keys, a new rhythm each time.

Bar by bar, play the key from the song (C or G) in the rhythm of the way. A dot means lift and wait.

Way 1
twice

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
C	—	C	—	D	—	D	—

Way 2
play, lift

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
C	○	C	○	D	○	D	○

Way 3
march

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
C	C	C	C	D	D	D	D

Way 4
long short short

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
C	—	C	C	D	—	D	D

SAY IT, TAP IT, PLAY IT

Say the name of the way out loud in time. Tap it on your knee with the left hand. Then play it with the song.

☐ Way 1 ☐ Way 2 ☐ Way 3 ☐ Way 4

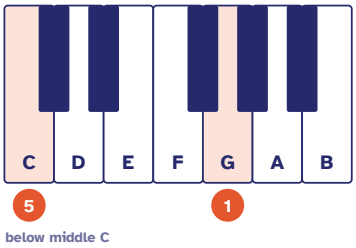
SONG 3

Au Clair de la Lune

A French song by moonlight. Play it softly, at bedtime.

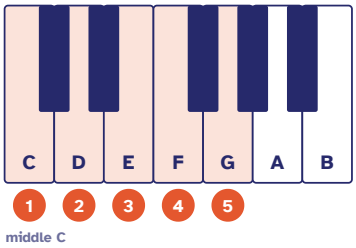
Hear it first

LEFT HAND



C with finger 5, G with the thumb.

RIGHT HAND



Thumb on middle C, one finger for each key.

THE SONG

Some notes last two boxes. Count both, and keep holding through the line.

	1	1	1	2	3		2		1	3	2	2	1			
R.H.	C	C	C	D	E	—	D	—	C	E	D	D	C	—	—	—
	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
	Au	clair	de	la	lu-		ne		mon	a-	mi	Pier-	rot			
L.H.	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—

	1	1	1	2	3		2		1	3	2	2	1			
R.H.	C	C	C	D	E	—	D	—	C	E	D	D	C	—	—	—
	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
	Prê-	te-	moi	ta	plu-		me		pour	é-	crire	un	mot			
L.H.	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—

☐ **Left hand alone** ☐ **Right hand alone** ☐ **Both hands** ☐ **For someone**

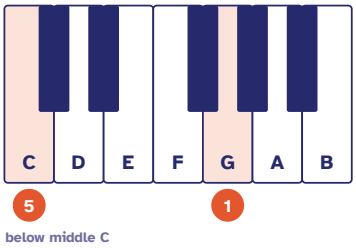
SONG 4

Lightly Row

A boat song. Play it smoothly, like rowing on still water.

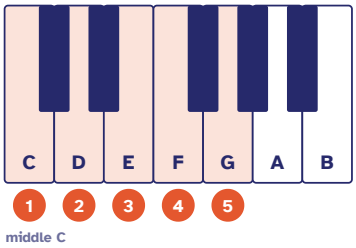
Hear it first

LEFT HAND



C with finger 5, G with the thumb.

RIGHT HAND



Thumb on middle C, one finger for each key.

THE SONG

Count out loud, 1 2 3 4. One letter, one box. A line means keep holding.

	5	3	3		4	2	2		1	2	3	4	5	5	5	
R.H.	G	E	E	—	F	D	D	—	C	D	E	F	G	G	G	—
	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
	Light-	ly	row		light-	ly	row		o'er	the	glass-	y	waves	we	go	
L.H.	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—

	5	3	3		4	2	2		1	3	5	5	1			
R.H.	G	E	E	—	F	D	D	—	C	E	G	G	C	—	—	—
	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
	Smooth-	ly	glide		smooth-	ly	glide		on	the	si-	lent	tide			
L.H.	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—

☐ Left hand alone ☐ Right hand alone ☐ Both hands ☐ For someone

SONG 4 · THE LEFT HAND, AGAIN

Lightly Row, Four Ways

Lightly Row again. The left hand learns to wait, and to come in late.

Still one box, one beat. A dot means lift and wait. On beats 2 and 4, the left hand is the drummer.

Way 1
wait for it

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
C	—	—	C	D	—	—	D

Way 2
on 2 and 4

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
○	C	○	C	○	D	○	D

Way 3
short long short

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
C	C	—	C	D	D	—	D

Way 4
rest, go

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
○	C	C	C	○	D	D	D

SAY IT, TAP IT, PLAY IT

Say the name of the way out loud in time. Tap it on your knee with the left hand. Then play it with the song.

☐ Way 1 ☐ Way 2 ☐ Way 3 ☐ Way 4

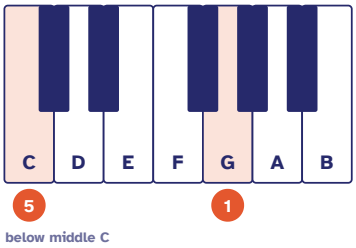
SONG 5

Ode to Joy

Beethoven's most famous tune, and now it is yours. Play it after dinner.

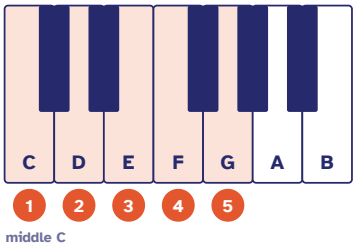
Hear it first

LEFT HAND



C with finger 5, G with the thumb.

RIGHT HAND



Thumb on middle C, one finger for each key.

THE SONG

A big tune made of small steps. Look for the line that comes back.

	3	3	4	5	5	4	3	2	1	1	2	3	3	2	2	
R.H.	E	E	F	G	G	F	E	D	C	C	D	E	E	D	D	—
	1 Joy-	2 ful,	3 joy-	4 ful,	1 we	2 a-	3 dore	4 thee,	1 God	2 of	3 glo-	4 ry,	1 Lord	2 of	3 love;	4
L.H.	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—

	3	3	4	5	5	4	3	2	1	1	2	3	2	1	1	
R.H.	E	E	F	G	G	F	E	D	C	C	D	E	D	C	C	—
	1 hearts	2 un-	3 fold	4 like	1 flowers	2 be-	3 fore	4 thee,	1 o-	2 pening	3 to	4 the	1 sun	2 a-	3 bove	4
L.H.	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—

☐ Left hand alone ☐ Right hand alone ☐ Both hands ☐ For someone

SONG 5 · THE LEFT HAND, AGAIN

Ode to Joy, Four Ways

Ode to Joy again. Rests in new places: the left hand starts to talk back to the tune.

Big beats only. Count out loud; the dot is a lift. On G bars, the same rhythm on G.

Way 1
hold, lift, go

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
C	—	○	C	D	—	○	D

Way 2
play, lift, two

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
C	○	C	C	D	○	D	D

Way 3
late start

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
○	○	C	—	○	○	D	—

Way 4
the answer

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
○	C	—	C	○	D	—	D

SAY IT, TAP IT, PLAY IT

Say the name of the way out loud in time. Tap it on your knee with the left hand. Then play it with the song.

☐ Way 1 ☐ Way 2 ☐ Way 3 ☐ Way 4

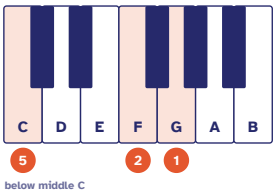
SONG 6

Jingle Bells

December's favourite. Play it, and the whole room sings.

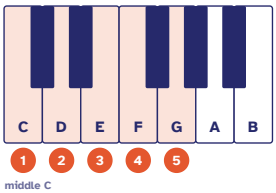
Hear it first

LEFT HAND



C with 5, F with 2, G with the thumb.

RIGHT HAND



Thumb on middle C, one finger for each key.

THE SONG

New for the left hand: F, with finger 2. It comes twice, in the same place each time.

R.H.	3	3	3		3	3	3		3	5	1	2	3				4	4	4	4	4	3	3	3 3
	E	E	E	—	E	E	E	—	E	G	C	D	E	—	—	—	F	F	F	F	F	E	E	E E
	1 Jin-	2 gle	3 bells	4	1 jin-	2 gle	3 bells	4	1 jin-	2 gle	3 all	4 the	1 way	2	3	4	1 oh	2 what	3 fun	4 it	1 is	2 to	3 ride	4 & in a
L.H.	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	F	—	—	—	C	—	—	—
R.H.	3	3	3		3	3	3		3	5	1	2	3				4	4	4	4	4	3	3	3 3
	E	E	E	—	E	E	E	—	E	G	C	D	E	—	—	—	F	F	F	F	F	E	E	E E
	1 Jin-	2 gle	3 bells	4	1 jin-	2 gle	3 bells	4	1 jin-	2 gle	3 all	4 the	1 way	2	3	4	1 oh	2 what	3 fun	4 it	1 is	2 to	3 ride	4 & in a
L.H.	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	F	—	—	—	C	—	—	—
R.H.	5	5	4	2	1																			
	G	G	F	D	C	—	—	—																
	1 one-	2 horse	3 o-	4 pen	1 sleigh!	2	3	4																
L.H.	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—																

- [ ] Left hand alone
- [ ] Right hand alone
- [ ] Both hands
- [ ] For someone

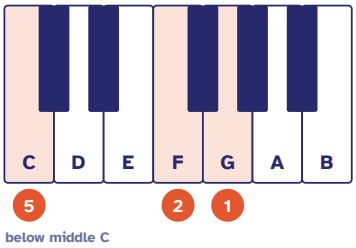
SONG 7

Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star

The first song most people ever learn. Play it at bedtime, under the stars.

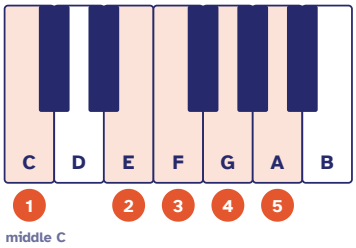
Hear it first

LEFT HAND



C with 5, F with 2, G with the thumb.

RIGHT HAND



4 on G, 5 on A. Later the thumb slides up to D, then back to C.

THE SONG

The right hand meets a new key, A. Find it before you start.

R.H.	1 C	1 C	4 G	4 G	5 A	5 A	4 G	—	4 F	4 F	3 E	3 E	2 D	2 D	1 C	—
	1 Twin-	2 kle	3 twin-	4 kle	1 lit-	2 tle	3 star	4	1 how	2 I	3 won-	4 der	1 what	2 you	3 are	4
L.H.	C	—	—	—	F	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—
R.H.	5 G	5 G	4 F	4 F	3 E	3 E	2 D	—	5 G	5 G	4 F	4 F	3 E	3 E	2 D	—
	1 Up	2 a-	3 bove	4 the	1 world	2 so	3 high	4	1 like	2 a	3 dia-	4 mond	1 in	2 the	3 sky	4
L.H.	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—
R.H.	1 C	1 C	4 G	4 G	5 A	5 A	4 G	—	4 F	4 F	3 E	3 E	2 D	2 D	1 C	—
	1 Twin-	2 kle	3 twin-	4 kle	1 lit-	2 tle	3 star	4	1 how	2 I	3 won-	4 der	1 what	2 you	3 are	4
L.H.	C	—	—	—	F	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—

☐ Left hand alone ☐ Right hand alone ☐ Both hands ☐ For someone

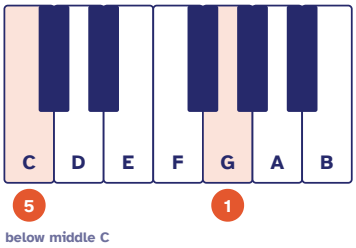
SONG 8

London Bridge

A game song: two people make the bridge, everyone else runs under. You are the music.

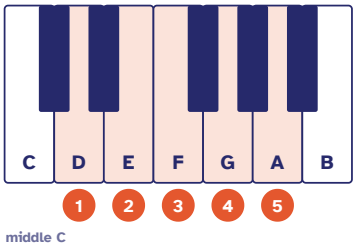
Hear it first

LEFT HAND



C with finger 5, G with the thumb.

RIGHT HAND



Thumb on D. At the very end it slides down to C.

THE SONG

A comes back. The song starts on G, the top of the hand.

	4	5	4	3	2	3	4		1	2	3		2	3	4	
R.H.	G	A	G	F	E	F	G	—	D	E	F	—	E	F	G	—
	1 Lon-	2 don	3 bridge	4 is	1 fall-	2 ing	3 down	4	1 fall-	2 ing	3 down	4	1 fall-	2 ing	3 down	4
L.H.	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—

	4	5	4	3	2	3	4		1		4		2	1		
R.H.	G	A	G	F	E	F	G	—	D	—	G	—	E	C	—	—
	1 Lon-	2 don	3 bridge	4 is	1 fall-	2 ing	3 down	4	1 my	2	3 fair	4	1 la-	2 dy	3	4
L.H.	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—

☐ Left hand alone ☐ Right hand alone ☐ Both hands ☐ For someone

SONG 8 · THE LEFT HAND, AGAIN

London Bridge, Two Keys

Two keys together now. For C: C and G, fingers 5 and 1. For G: the thumb stays on G and finger 4 takes D.

The hand stays where it is: only one finger moves, 5 on C or 4 on D. The thumb lives on G.

Way 1
together

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
G C	—	—	—	G D	—	—	—

Way 2
twice

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
G C	—	G C	—	G D	—	G D	—

Way 3
bottom, top

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
C	—	G	—	D	—	G	—

Way 4
oom-pah

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
C	G	C	G	D	G	D	G

SAY IT, TAP IT, PLAY IT

Say the name of the way out loud in time. Tap it on your knee with the left hand. Then play it with the song.

- [ ] Way 1
- [ ] Way 2
- [ ] Way 3
- [ ] Way 4

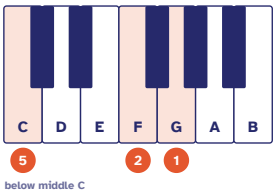
SONG 9

When the Saints Go Marching In

A parade song from New Orleans. March around the room to it first.

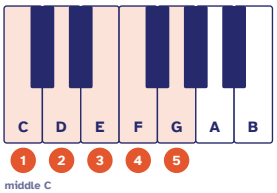
Hear it first

LEFT HAND



C with 5, F with 2, G with the thumb.

RIGHT HAND



Thumb on middle C, one finger for each key.

THE SONG

New: an empty box with a dot is a rest. Count it, but stay quiet.

R.H.	○	1 **C**	3 **E**	4 **F**	5 **G**	—	—	—	○	1 **C**	3 **E**	4 **F**	5 **G**	—	—	—
	1	2 Oh	3 when	4 the	1 saints	2	3	4	1	2 go	3 march-	4 ing	1 in	2	3	4
L.H.	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—
R.H.	○	1 **C**	3 **E**	4 **F**	5 **G**	—	3 **E**	—	1 **C**	—	3 **E**	—	2 **D**	—	—	—
	1	2 Oh	3 when	4 the	1 saints	2	3 go	4	1 march-	2	3 ing	4	1 in	2	3	4
L.H.	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—
R.H.	○	3 **E**	3 **E**	2 **D**	1 **C**	—	—	1 **C**	3 **E**	—	5 **G**	5 **G**	5 **G**	4 **F**	—	—
	1	2 Oh	3 Lord,	4 I	1 want	2	3	4 to	1 be	2	3 in	4 that	1 num-	2 ber	3	4
L.H.	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	F	—	—	—
R.H.	○	1 **C**	3 **E**	4 **F**	5 **G**	—	3 **E**	—	1 **C**	—	2 **D**	—	1 **C**	—	—	—
	1	2 Oh	3 when	4 the	1 saints	2	3 go	4	1 march-	2	3 ing	4	1 in	2	3	4
L.H.	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—

☐ **Left hand alone** ☐ **Right hand alone** ☐ **Both hands** ☐ **For someone**

SONG 9 · THE LEFT HAND, AGAIN

When the Saints, Three Shapes

Two keys on every chord, and F joins in. The hand still stays put: C and G, C and F, D and G.

C chord: C and G (5 and 1). F chord: C and F (5 and 2). G chord: D and G (4 and 1).

Way 1
together

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
G C	—	—	—	F C	—	—	—	G D	—	—	—

Way 2
twice

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
G C	—	G C	—	F C	—	F C	—	G D	—	G D	—

Way 3
bottom, top

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
C	—	G	—	C	—	F	—	D	—	G	—

Way 4
oom-pah

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
C	G	C	G	C	F	C	F	D	G	D	G

SAY IT, TAP IT, PLAY IT

Say the name of the way out loud in time. Tap it on your knee with the left hand. Then play it with the song.

- [ ] Way 1
- [ ] Way 2
- [ ] Way 3
- [ ] Way 4

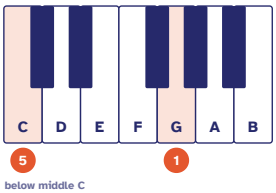
SONG 10

Are You Sleeping?

A round: when you can play it, someone else starts it two bars after you.

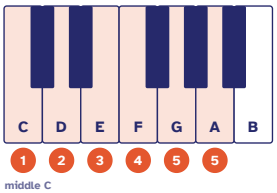
Hear it first

LEFT HAND



C with 5. The thumb waits on G.

RIGHT HAND



Finger 5 reaches to A again, then back to G.

THE SONG

New: a tune note for the left hand. Where the right hand says L.H., your left thumb plays G.

R.H.	1 C	2 D	3 E	1 C	1 C	2 D	3 E	1 C
	1 Are	2 you	3 sleep-	4 ing	1 are	2 you	3 sleep-	4 ing
L.H.	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—
R.H.	3 E	4 F	5 G	—	3 E	4 F	5 G	—
	1 Bro-	2 ther	3 John	4	1 Bro-	2 ther	3 John	4
L.H.	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—
R.H.	4 G · 5 A	4 G · 3 F	2 E	1 C	4 G · 5 A	4 G · 3 F	2 E	1 C
	1 Morn · & ing	2 bells · & are	3 ring-	4 ing	1 morn · & ing	2 bells · & are	3 ring-	4 ing
L.H.	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—
R.H.	1 C	L.H.	1 C	—	1 C	L.H.	1 C	—
	1 ding	2 dang	3 dong	4	1 ding	2 dang	3 dong	4
L.H.	C	G	—	—	C	G	—	—

☐ Left hand alone ☐ Right hand alone ☐ Both hands ☐ For someone

SONG 10 · THE LEFT HAND, AGAIN

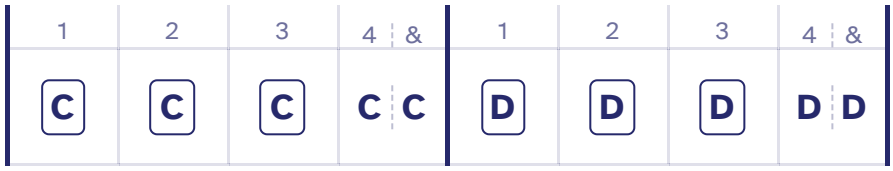
Are You Sleeping?, Four Ways

Now a beat can split in two for the left hand too: two quick keys in one box.

Say "run-ning" for a split box. On G bars, the same rhythm on G; in the last two bars, keep your thumb free for the tune.

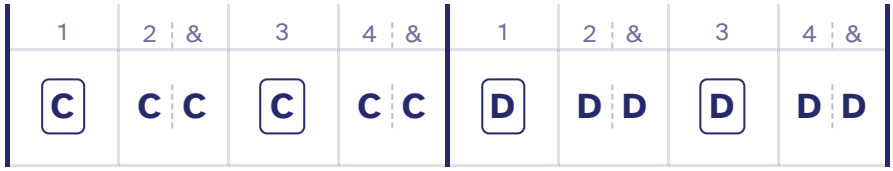
Way 1

march, run-ning



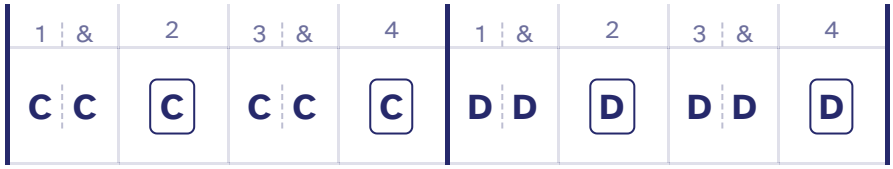
Way 2

walk, run-ning



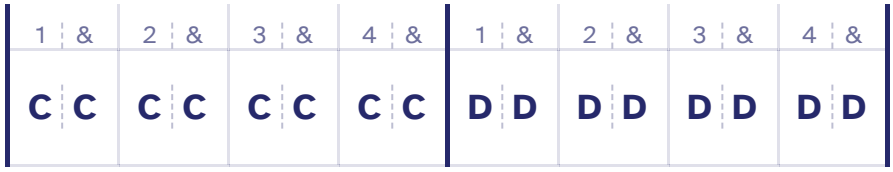
Way 3

run-ning, walk



Way 4

running



SAY IT, TAP IT, PLAY IT

Say the name of the way out loud in time. Tap it on your knee with the left hand. Then play it with the song.

- [ ] Way 1
- [ ] Way 2
- [ ] Way 3
- [ ] Way 4

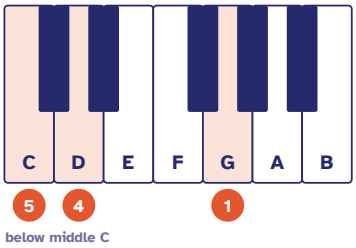
SONG 11

Camptown Races

A racing song: fast, bright and full of "doo-dah". Now every chord gets two keys.

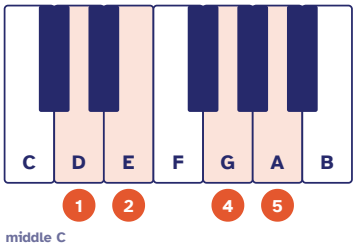
Hear it first

LEFT HAND



C chord: C and G (5, 1). G chord: D and G (4, 1).

RIGHT HAND



Thumb on D, 2 on E, 4 on G, 5 on A. At the end the thumb slides to C.

THE SONG

The L.H. boxes now hold two keys: play the bottom and top together, once a bar.

R.H.	4 G	4 G	2 E	4 G	5 A	4 G	2 E	—	2 E	1 D	—	—	2 E	1 D	—	—
	1 Camp-	2 town	3 la-	4 dies	1 sing	2 this	3 song	4	1 doo-	2 dah	3	4	1 doo-	2 dah	3	4
L.H.	G C	—	—	—	G C	—	—	—	G C	—	—	—	G C	—	—	—

R.H.	4 G	4 G	2 E	4 G	5 A	4 G	2 E	—	1 D	1 D	2 E	1 D	1 C	—	—	—
	1 Camp-	2 town	3 race-	4 track	1 five	2 miles	3 long	4	1 oh,	2 doo-	3 dah	4	1 day!	2	3	4
L.H.	G C	—	—	—	G C	—	—	—	G D	—	—	—	G C	—	—	—

☐ Left hand alone ☐ Right hand alone ☐ Both hands ☐ For someone

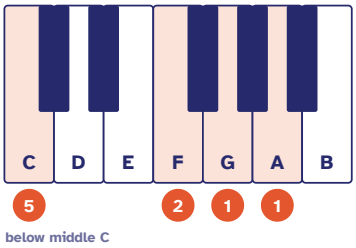
SONG 12

Old MacDonald Had a Farm

Everyone knows it, so everyone joins in. Make the animal noises too.

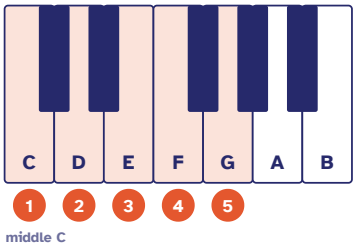
Hear it first

LEFT HAND



C with 5, F with 2, G with the thumb. The thumb also plays A, one key up.

RIGHT HAND



Thumb on middle C, one finger for each key.

THE SONG

When the left hand has the tune (L.H.), it plays no chord in that bar: one job at a time.

	1	1	1						3	3	2	2	1			
R.H.	C	C	C	L.H.	L.H.	L.H.	L.H.	—	E	E	D	D	C	—	—	L.H.
	1 Old	2 Mac-	3 Don-	4 ald	1 had	2 a	3 farm	4	1 E	2 I	3 E	4 I	1 O	2	3	4 and
L.H.	C	—	—	G	A	A	G	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	G

	1	1	1						3	3	2	2	1			
R.H.	C	C	C	L.H.	L.H.	L.H.	L.H.	—	E	E	D	D	C	—	—	—
	1 on	2 his	3 farm	4 he	1 had	2 a	3 cow	4	1 E	2 I	3 E	4 I	1 O	2	3	4
L.H.	C	—	—	G	A	A	G	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—

☐ Left hand alone ☐ Right hand alone ☐ Both hands ☐ For someone

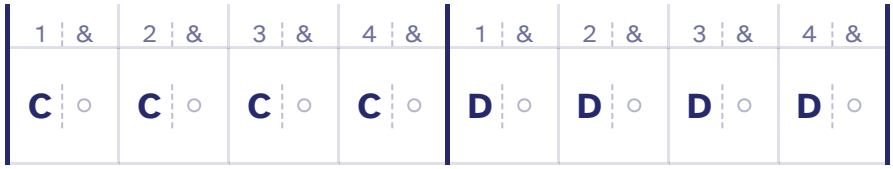
SONG 12 · THE LEFT HAND, AGAIN

Old MacDonald Had a Farm, Four Ways

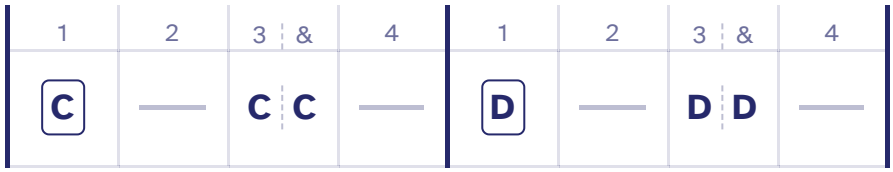
The split box again, and now the left hand finds the "&" between the beats.

Count "1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &". The dot is a lift. Play the ways in the bars that have a chord box.

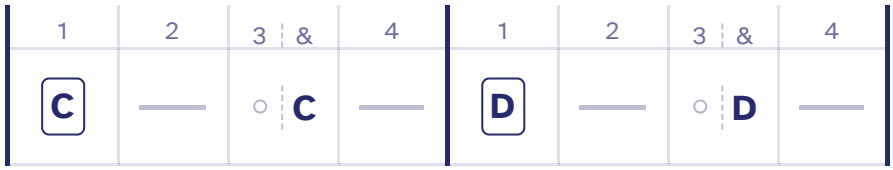
Way 1
tap, lift



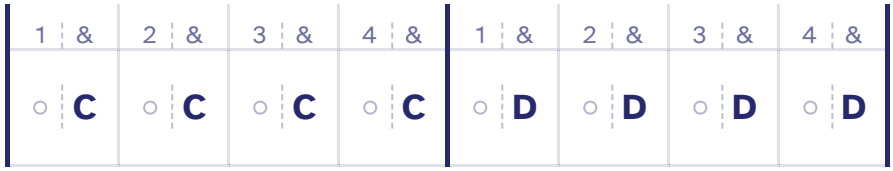
Way 2
skip



Way 3
the push



Way 4
on the &



SAY IT, TAP IT, PLAY IT

Say the name of the way out loud in time. Tap it on your knee with the left hand. Then play it with the song.

☐ Way 1 ☐ Way 2 ☐ Way 3 ☐ Way 4